Show Recorder

Quick reference — multitrack recording for front of house

Every input of the show to its own file, the stereo mix for the band that night, and the stems for whoever mixes it later; songs found, mixed, mastered and exported in the same window. Hover over any button for its key; **Ctrl+Alt+K** lists every shortcut. The full manual is the **Reference Manual**, beside this guide in the download.

Before the show

Interfaces	(Settings → Audio) **Multitrack**: every track records from and plays back to it. **Sub-Mixer and Sync out**: where L/R Mix, Ambient Bus, Master, Click and LTC play out. **Clock**: Shared (word clock, one Dante grandmaster) or Separate (the engine corrects the drift).
From the console	**New Session** → **From the console** builds the tracks from the desk's named input channels, stereo pairs from "L" / "R" names, with the desk's colours. **Sync from Console** (Ctrl+Alt+R) renames an existing session's tracks. Both read the desk through **MIDI Bridge** (free); start it first.
Last night	**New Session** from last night's session or a template: its tracks, patch and mix, no audio.
Patch	Select tracks, type a channel, **Inputs** / **Outputs** to cascade. **Patch Matrix**: click or drag down to patch, Shift+drag one side of a pair, Opt+click to unpatch. Amber: a channel recorded twice.
Recording panel	Time left on the disk at the armed tracks against your **Show length**; **Format** 24-bit or 32-bit float; **Record rate** 44.1–192 kHz, whatever the interface runs at (converted; the interface is never changed); **Buffer** 1024 frames by default (**Settings**, Cmd+comma, with show length and auto-lock). Warns on too little space, a FAT32 drive's 4 GB limit, a network volume. **Before You Record** (Ctrl+Alt+P) lists anything that would spoil the take.

Recording

Ctrl+Alt+Space / Space	Record every armed track / stop the take. During a take Space only stops it.
Files	One WAV per track (stereo: L and R) in the session's **audio/Take NNN**, stamped with where it starts. The take lands on its tracks and the session saves at Stop.
Waveforms	Draw as the take records, a second or so behind; complete the moment you press Stop.
Timecode	Patch the LTC row to the code's input: the transport row shows it (green when locked) and each take notes its start. **Record when timecode runs** starts a take on lock and stops it 5 s after the code goes; your own takes stay yours. Takes land at their code (**Session start timecode** sets the timeline); **Follow timecode in playback** (the **LTC** button) follows it. All in **Settings** → **Sync**; MTC out, MTC and MMC in: Settings → MIDI. Nothing goes out during a take.
Dropouts	The transport row's counter: the disk falling behind or refusing audio, playback or Sub-Mixer and Sync streaming, the interface stopping (it blinks until it's back). Each is a warning marker on the timeline; click the counter for details and Reset.
Show-day safety	**Rec-safe**: Opt+click a track's arm (amber ring): its arming, input and width are locked. **Lock** (the header, Cmd+Shift+L) stops stray keys and clicks; hold Escape a second to unlock; **Auto-lock** (Settings) after idle minutes in a take. The Mac stays awake during a take. **Remove Last Capture** (File menu) moves a false start to the dead folder; Cmd+Z undoes it. **Floating Meters** (Shift+Cmd+M) stays above every app: REC, time left, dropouts, a meter per track, growing with the window; its top-right menu sets their size and shows FOH as bars or with loudness and phase.

A crash or power cut never loses a take: it is recovered when the session next opens. Every save also keeps a timestamped backup of the session in its backup folder.

After the show

Find Songs	Markers → Find Songs: a region for every song in the L/R Mix, split at its quiet gaps. Rename them, then export each song.
Markers & regions	Opt+M marker (Opt+Shift+M named) · Opt+R region from the selection · [and] to step · G / Shift+G go to one · Ctrl+Alt+M the list. Drag to move, double-click to rename.
Mixer	The export mix: each track's level, pan, mute, solo and bus; L/R Mix and Ambient Bus with a bus compressor; the Master.
Processing	The master's chain: **EQ** (24 bands, dynamic, linear phase) → **Comp** → **Tape** → **Clip** → fader → **Limit** (eight styles, true peak). Each bus has the EQ. Heard live; dither only on export.
FOH meter	L/R bars (bar average, dot peak), momentary, short-term and integrated loudness, LRA, true peak and correlation: the master in playback, the console's L/R Mix otherwise. Reset starts them over.
Export (Cmd+E)	The stereo mix and/or the stems; the whole show, each song, or the selection; WAV 24-bit, 32-bit float or 16-bit dithered. Runs in the background; gives each mix's loudness and true peak when done.
Virtual soundcheck	Play sends every track back out its patched output. **Playback out where it came in** sets that patch in one click.
Console scenes	With MIDI Bridge running, each scene the desk recalls during a take is an orange marker. **Recall scenes in playback** (off until you turn it on) recalls the scene in effect at the play cursor whenever it changes, jumps included.

The timeline

Space / Home / T	Play-stop / go to start / locate to a time or timecode. Shift+L loops.
Zoom	Cmd+= / Cmd+– / Cmd+0 fit · Cmd+Shift+0 the selection · pinch or Opt+scroll at the pointer. Ctrl+Alt+Up / Down track height, Ctrl+Alt+= / – waveform size.
Clips	Click, Shift+click to select · drag to move (snaps; Cmd drags freely; N snap on/off) · Opt+Left / Right nudge 10 ms (Shift: 1 s) · Delete · L locks.
Import Audio (Cmd+I)	Stems from another DAW: split pairs joined, poly files split, DAW numbers removed, placed by timestamp, matched onto tracks by name. One undo.
Undo	Cmd+Z / Shift+Cmd+Z: every track, patch, clip, marker and mix edit.
Tracks	Drag a track's number to reorder, or Cmd+Up / Down; inputs among inputs, ambient among ambient. The FOH meter's picker reads any track, or two mono ones, for correlation.
Number pad	0 play-stop · 3 record · Enter marker · . n . to marker n. **Schedule…** (Recording panel) starts and/or stops a take by the clock.

Beta, licence, help

The beta	Everything works until **30 Nov 2026**. After that a beta opens, plays, edits and exports, but starts no new recording. Checked once, at launch: a take is never stopped.
Licence	Free: a take records up to 8 tracks, everything else in full. A licence unlocks any number, on two Macs, for this and **every future version, with no upgrade fees**. Activating is the only time the app goes online.
Export log	In the footer: a diagnostics zip on your Desktop. Send it with any report. Logs live in ~/Library/Logs/dylanmaudio/Show Recorder/.

What's new in v0.2.15

• The DiGiCo SD's names, through MIDI Bridge 1.4.111 or later: New Session from the console and Sync from Console read its channels, auxes, groups and matrices; its factory names ("Ch 4", "Aux 2") are left out.
• On the DiGiCo SD, a scene marker remembers the snapshot's number as its screen shows it (2.00, or an inserted 1.50), and Recall in Playback recalls that snapshot even after snapshots were inserted or deleted above it. If the desk no longer has the number, nothing is recalled rather than the wrong one. Needs MIDI Bridge 1.4.111 or later; a session opened in an earlier Show Recorder still opens, and recalls by place.
• Recall in Playback only recalls on the kind of console the scene markers came from: a show recorded on an SD and played back with MIDI Bridge on a dLive recalls nothing there, instead of the dLive's scenes of the same numbers. Sessions whose markers predate 0.2.15 recall as before.
• A named channel next to an unnamed one is no longer guessed to be a stereo pair on the Wing or the SD (the guess is the dLive's, whose unnamed right half shows its number).